

Camp Community College EMS Program Student Handbook

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1. Welcome and Introduction

Welcome Message from the Program Director

Dear Students,

I welcome you to our Emergency Medical Services (EMS) Program. At Camp Community College, we are committed to providing you with the highest-quality education and training to prepare you for a rewarding career in EMS.

Our program offers a comprehensive curriculum to equip you with the knowledge, skills, and hands-on experience necessary to excel in this critical field. You will learn from experienced professionals dedicated to your success and passionate about the EMS profession.

Program Highlights

- Career Studies Certificates: We offer certificates in Emergency Medical Technician (EMT) (8 credits), Advanced Emergency Medical Technician (AEMT) (11 credits), and Paramedic (33 credits), in addition to an Associate Degree (AAS) in EMS (65 credits).
- Letters of Review: Camp Community College is Virginia's ONLY EMS program with Letters of Review (LOR) from CoAEMSP for both AEMT and Paramedic programs.
- Certification Preparation: Our program prepares you for certification at the National Registry of Emergency Medical Technicians (NREMT) level and certification through the Virginia Department of Health.
- Hands-On Training: You will participate in simulation lab training and practical sessions in regional ambulances and emergency departments.
- Flexible Learning Options: We provide traditional and accelerated course formats to fit your schedule.
- Career Opportunities: Graduates are well-prepared for careers as EMTs, AEMTs, and Paramedics, with a strong job outlook and competitive salaries in the Hampton Roads Workforce Region.
- Advanced Standing Placement: Students certified by the State of Virginia Office of EMS or the National Registry of EMTs as Advanced Emergency Medical Technicians (AEMT) will receive 11 credits and advanced placement into the Paramedic program.
- Credit for Prior Learning: Current EMS professionals may receive credit for certifications and experience.

You will have access to state-of-the-art facilities, comprehensive coursework, and real-world training opportunities throughout your time with us. We are here to support you every step of the way, ensuring you are well-prepared to meet the challenges and demands of the EMS profession.

Thank you for choosing Camp Community College for your EMS education. We look forward to seeing you grow and succeed in becoming an exceptional EMS professional.

Best regards,

Dr. Carlos Cajares, DHSc, MPA, NRP

EMS Program Director

Camp Community College

Mission and Vision of the EMS Program

Mission Statement

The mission of the Emergency Medical Services (EMS) Program at Camp Community College is to provide accessible, high-quality education and training that prepares students to excel as emergency medical professionals. We are dedicated to fostering a learning environment that emphasizes clinical excellence, ethical practice, and compassionate care, ensuring our graduates are well-equipped to meet the healthcare needs of our community.

Vision Statement

Our vision is to be our region's leading EMS education provider, recognized for our commitment to student success, innovative teaching methods, and strong community partnerships. We strive to produce highly skilled and knowledgeable EMS professionals who are prepared to respond to the evolving challenges of emergency medical services and contribute positively to the health and well-being of the communities they serve.

Minimum Program Expectation

To prepare EMT, AEMT, and Paramedics who are competent in the cognitive (knowledge), psychomotor (skills), and affective (behavior) learning domains to enter the profession.

Overview of the EMS Profession

Emergency Medical Services (EMS) is a critical component of the healthcare system, providing urgent medical care and transportation to individuals experiencing acute medical emergencies. EMS professionals, including EMTs, AEMTs, and Paramedics, are trained to respond swiftly and effectively to a wide range of medical situations, from heart attacks and strokes to traumatic injuries and respiratory distress.

Levels of EMS Certification

Emergency Medical Technician (EMT):

- Role: EMTs provide basic life support (BLS) and are often the first to arrive on the scene.
- Skills: Patient assessment, CPR, AED use, oxygen administration, basic wound care, and splinting.
- Training: Approximately 150-260 hours of initial education
- Credits: 8 Credits (EMS 111 + EMS 120)
- Tuition: \$1,376 (In-State)
- Average Salary: \$37,720/year (Hampton Roads)

Advanced Emergency Medical Technician (AEMT):

- Role: AEMTs provide advanced life support (ALS) beyond the EMT level.
- Skills: All EMT skills plus advanced airway management, intravenous (IV) therapy, administration of additional medications, and advanced patient assessment.
- Training: Typically 200-300 hours, with additional clinical hours in hospital and ambulance settings
- Credits: 11 Credits
- Tuition: \$1,891 (In-State)
- Average Salary: \$42,077/year (Hampton Roads)
- Letter of Review: Virginia's ONLY CoAEMSP Letter of Review for AEMT

Paramedic (PM):

- Role: Paramedics provide the highest level of pre-hospital care.
- Skills: All AEMT skills plus advanced cardiac life support (ACLS), pediatric advanced life support (PALS), advanced pharmacology, and ECG interpretation.
- Training: Over 1,500 hours of education, including extensive clinical and field experience
- Credits: 33 Credits (Paramedic courses only)
- Tuition: \$5,674 (In-State)
- Average Salary: \$45,266/year (Hampton Roads)
- Letter of Review: Virginia's CoAEMSP Letter of Review for Paramedic

2. Program Overview

Description of the EMS Program

The Emergency Medical Services (EMS) Program at Camp Community College provides comprehensive education and training for individuals seeking careers in emergency medical care. The program offers traditional and accelerated pathways to accommodate diverse student needs, equipping graduates with the knowledge and practical skills required to excel in the field.

Key Features

- Program Tracks: Career Studies Certificates in Emergency Medical Technician (EMT), Advanced Emergency Medical Technician (AEMT), and Paramedic (PM), in addition to the associate degree track for Paramedics (AAS in EMS).
- Hands-On Experience: Extensive training in simulation labs and real-world settings, including regional ambulances and emergency departments.
- Flexible Learning Options: Courses designed to fit a variety of schedules, including evening and weekend offerings.
- Three Campus Locations: Suffolk (Hobbs Campus), Franklin (Main Campus/Workforce Development Center), and Smithfield.
- Community Impact: Graduates are prepared to address the Hampton Roads region's critical needs and contribute to public health and safety.

Accreditation and Certification Information

The EMS Program at Camp Community College is fully accredited by the Virginia Office of Emergency Medical Services (VAOEMS), which ensures that the program meets all state regulatory requirements for EMS education.

A Letter of Review (LOR) has been approved by the Committee on Accreditation of Educational Programs for the Emergency Medical Services Professions (CoAEMSP). Camp Community College EMS Program has been approved to offer both AEMT and Paramedic programs by the recommendation of the Committee on Accreditation of Educational Programs for the Emergency Medical Services Professions (CoAEMSP) to the Commission on Accreditation of Allied Health Education Programs (CAAHEP).

Camp Community College is Virginia's ONLY EMS program with Letters of Review for both AEMT.

Graduates of the program are eligible to take the National Registry of Emergency Medical Technicians (NREMT) certification exams, which are required for state certification and licensure.

Program Goals and Objectives

The EMS Program is committed to preparing students to become competent, ethical, and compassionate emergency medical professionals.

Program Goals

- Equip students with the cognitive knowledge to assess and manage various emergency medical situations.

- Develop students' psychomotor skills to perform advanced lifesaving procedures and interventions.
- Foster professionalism and effective communication to ensure high-quality patient care and collaboration with healthcare teams.

Program Objectives

- Provide a curriculum aligned with the latest National EMS Education Standards.
- Deliver practical experiences in diverse clinical and field settings to ensure real-world readiness.
- Support students' cognitive, psychomotor, and affective learning development to achieve entry-level competency.
- Prepare graduates for success on certification exams and licensure processes.
- Promote lifelong learning and professional development to adapt to evolving industry standards and community needs.

3. Admission Requirements and Health Standards

Eligibility Criteria

EMT Level Requirements

- High school diploma or GED equivalent
- Minimum age of 16 years
- Valid driver's license
- English language proficiency for reading medical texts and documentation
- Computer literacy for online coursework and digital platforms
- Successful completion of criminal background check
- Successful completion of drug screening
- Physical and mental abilities to safely perform EMT functions
- Immunization documentation against communicable diseases
- CPR certification (provided in first week if not already obtained)

AEMT/Paramedic Level Requirements

- High school diploma or GED equivalent
- Minimum age of 18 years
- Current EMT certification or equivalent training
- Valid driver's license
- English language proficiency for reading medical texts and documentation
- Computer literacy for online coursework and digital platforms
- Successful completion of criminal background check
- Successful completion of drug screening
- Physical and mental abilities to safely perform AEMT/Paramedic functions
- Current immunization documentation
- American Heart Association CPR Certification: Applicants must hold a valid American Heart Association Basic Life Support (BLS) for Healthcare Providers certification

Application Process

The EMS Program is open enrollment at Camp Community College. These are the steps for college admission:

Step 1: Apply for Admission

- Complete an application online at apply.vccs.edu (No application fee)
- Log in to navigate and review your To-Do List
- Complete the Advising Questionnaire

Step 2: Apply for Financial Aid

- Complete and submit the Free Application for Federal Student Aid (FAFSA) at www.fafsa.gov
- Camp Community College school code is 009159
- G3 Tuition Assistance is available for eligible students

Step 3: Order Transcripts and/or Score Reports (if applicable)

- Order official transcripts from other colleges/universities attended

- Send to transcripts@pdc.edu or Camp Community College, ATTN: College Registrar, 100 N College Dr., Franklin, VA 23851

Step 4: Meet with Enrollment Navigator/Advisor/EMS Program Director

- Discuss entrance requirements and course scheduling
- Register for classes (Note: You cannot register for EMS Classes online via MyCamp)
- Contact Dr. Cajares, Dr. Sheaffer, or your academic advisor

Step 5: Pay for Classes

- Pay tuition and fees by the deadline
- Pay in person, by dropbox, or by credit card online through MyCamp

Step 6: Obtain Your Picture ID

- Obtain your student ID picture from the library

Required Documentation and Health Requirements

To comply with clinical and field placement requirements, ALL Camp Community College EMS students must complete the following requirements before starting clinical and/or field rotations:

General Documentation

- Proof of valid American Heart Association CPR certification
- Proof of current Virginia State EMT certification (if applying for AEMT or Paramedic)
- Copy of Driver's License
- Copy of High School diploma or GED
- Copy of Camp Student ID
- Field sponsorship letter from agency for affiliating students (if applicable)

Health and Safety Requirements

- Physical Exam: Current physical exam (within 1 year). The Camp Health Professions physical examination form meets these requirements.
- Tuberculosis Screening: Current tuberculin test via the lab draw QuantiFERON Gold. A positive tuberculin test will require a chest x-ray.
- Immunizations: Varicella, MMR, TDAP (within 10 years), Hepatitis B (three-vaccine series), Influenza (annually)
- Declination form for any refusal of vaccinations

Training Requirements

- OSHA bloodborne pathogen training (available in Canvas EMS 120, EMS 170, EMS 241 shell)
- HIPAA training (available in Canvas EMS 120, EMS 170, EMS 241 shell)
- Attend Clinical/Field Orientation

Background Check

Verification of criminal and child/sex offender background check via Fieldprint VOEMS Site. The background check remains valid as long as you attend without interruption.

Credit for Prior Learning Policy

EMS professionals already certified as EMTs, AEMTs, or Paramedics may be eligible for credit toward experiential learning requirements. To receive credit, applicants must:

- Provide proof of current and valid state of Virginia or National Registry EMT, AEMT, or Paramedic certification
- Meet all Camp Community College academic and administrative requirements for credit transfer or prior learning assessment
- Be enrolled in the Camp Community College EMS Program and in good academic standing
- Maintain compliance with all health, safety, and professional requirements

4. Curriculum and Course Descriptions

Program Curriculum Outline

Upon enrollment, a comprehensive roadmap will be provided detailing the sequence of courses, clinical experiences, and field internships necessary to progress through the EMS program at Camp Community College.

Required Course Texts and Educational Resources

The Camp Community College EMS Program uses specific textbook packages established for Virginia Community College System EMS programs. These packages consolidate all EMS course educational resources into a single point-of-purchase package.

Online Course Resources

- Navigate Premier Access for EMT Flipped Classroom, Twelfth Edition
ISBN: 9781284303438 (<https://checkout.jblearning.com/cart/Default.aspx?bc=27751-7&ref=psg&coupon=pdc30>)
- Navigate Premier Access for Advanced Emergency Care and Transportation of the Sick and Injured, 4th Edition
ISBN: 9781284303414 (<https://checkout.jblearning.com/cart/Default.aspx?bc=27751-7&ref=psg&coupon=pdc30>)
- Navigate Premier Access for Sanders' Paramedic Textbook, Sixth Edition
ISBN: 9781284277517 (<https://checkout.jblearning.com/cart/Default.aspx?bc=27751-7&ref=psg&coupon=pdc30>)
- Sterling Credentials: Lab, Clinical and Field Scheduling, Skills Tracking, and Course Assessments

EMT Course Descriptions

EMS 100 - CPR for Healthcare Providers (1 Credit)

Provides instruction in Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation that meets current Emergency Cardiac Care (ECC) guidelines for Healthcare Providers. Lecture 1 hour per week. Equivalent to HLT 105.

EMS 111 - Emergency Medical Technician (7 Credits)

Prepares students for certification as Virginia and National Registry EMTs. Focuses on all aspects of pre-hospital basic life support defined by the Virginia Office of Emergency Medical Services curriculum for EMTs. Lecture 5 hours, Laboratory 4 hours per week. Prerequisite: EMS 100/equivalent. Co-requisite: EMS 120.

EMS 120 - Emergency Medical Technician Clinical (1 Credit)

Provides supervised direct patient contact, introducing the student to the assessment and emergency care of sick and injured patients. Laboratory 2 hours per week. Co-requisite: EMS 111.

AEMT Course Descriptions

EMS 180 - Advanced EMS Foundations (1 Credit)

Introduces fundamental concepts established by the National Emergency Medical Service Education Standards (NEMSES) for the Advanced EMT curriculum. Includes EMS systems, introduction to research, workforce safety and wellness, EMS system communications, therapeutic communication, and legal and ethical issues.

EMS 181 - Advanced Airway and Shock Management (1 Credit)

Introduces core airway, shock, and resuscitation principles outlined by NEMSES within the Advanced EMT curriculum. Provides fundamental knowledge of the cardiopulmonary system, including assessment and management of shock.

EMS 182 - Advanced Airway and Shock Management Lab (1 Credit)

Provides students with specific airway, resuscitation, and shock management skills. Laboratory 2 hours per week.

EMS 183 - Advanced Medical Care (2 Credits)

Examines the assessment and management of medical emergencies as outlined by NEMSES within the Advanced EMT curriculum. Lecture 2 hours per week.

EMS 184 - Advanced Medical Care Laboratory (1 Credit)

Focuses on specific skills related to assessing and managing common medical emergencies. Laboratory 2 hours per week.

EMS 185 - Advanced Trauma Care (2 Credits)

Examines the assessment and management of trauma emergencies outlined by NEMSES within the Advanced EMT curriculum. Lecture 2 hours per week.

EMS 186 - Advanced Trauma Care Laboratory (1 Credit)

Focuses on specific skills for assessing and managing trauma emergencies. Laboratory 2 hours per week.

EMS 170 - ALS Internship I (1-2 Credits)

Begins the first in a series of clinical experiences providing supervised direct patient contact in appropriate patient care facilities in and out of hospitals.

Paramedic Course Descriptions

EMS 221 - Paramedic Cardiovascular Care (2 Credits)

Covers the assessment and management of cardiac-related emergencies as outlined by NEMSES for Paramedics. Lecture 2 hours per week.

EMS 222 - Paramedic Cardiovascular Care Laboratory (1 Credit)

Focuses on skills involved in the assessment and management of cardiac-related emergencies. Develops competency in basic dysrhythmia recognition and overall cardiac patient care. Laboratory 2 hours per week.

EMS 223 - Paramedic Patient Care I (5 Credits)

Covers the breadth of medical and trauma conditions as outlined by NEMSES for Paramedics. Part I of II. Lecture 5 hours per week.

EMS 224 - Paramedic Patient Care I Laboratory (1 Credit)

Covers the skills related to the breadth of medical and trauma conditions. Part I of II. Laboratory 2 hours per week.

EMS 225 - Paramedic Patient Care II (5 Credits)

Covers the depth of medical and trauma conditions as outlined by NEMSES for Paramedics. Part II of II. Lecture 5 hours per week.

EMS 226 - Paramedic Patient Care II Laboratory (1 Credit)

Covers the skills related to the depth of medical and trauma conditions. Part II of II. Laboratory 2 hours per week.

EMS 210 - EMS Operations (1 Credit)

Covers medical incident management, hazardous materials awareness, rescue awareness and operations, crime scene awareness, and terrorism response.

EMS 212 - Leadership and Professional Development (1 Credit)

Covers civic engagement, personal wellness, resource management, and ethical leadership in EMS.

EMS 241 - Paramedic Internship I (1 Credit)

Introduces students to live patient assessment and management in the clinical and field setting. Begins a continuum of learning involving live patients. Laboratory 3 hours per week.

EMS 248 - Paramedic Comprehensive Field Experience (2 Credits)

Expands the student experience with live patient assessment and management into the field setting. Laboratory 6 hours per week.

EMS 249 - Paramedic Capstone Internship (2 Credits)

Provides a summative evaluation of the Paramedic student in the cognitive, psychomotor, and affective domains. This course serves as the final internship to ensure entry-level competence at the paramedic level. Laboratory 6 hours per week.

Grading System

Evaluation includes clinical performance, cognitive assessments, and adherence to program policies.

Minimum Passing Grade: A grade below 75% is considered unsatisfactory and may result in probation or dismissal from the program.

5. Academic Policies

Attendance and Participation

Mandatory Attendance: Attendance at all scheduled classes, clinical rotations, and field shifts is mandatory. Absence from more than 15% of instructional time may result in unsatisfactory attendance as per Virginia OEMS and program policies.

Cancellations and Emergencies: Cancellations for clinical or field shifts must be submitted at least 24 hours in advance unless it is due to an emergency. Failure to promptly notify the instructor or Clinical Coordinator will result in an unexcused absence.

Penalties for Excessive Cancellations: Students are permitted up to two cancellations per semester. Beyond this limit, each additional cancellation will result in a five-point grade deduction per incident. Chronic absenteeism may lead to probation or dismissal.

Academic Integrity and Code of Conduct

The EMS program upholds strict standards for academic and professional behavior to ensure the integrity of its students and graduates.

Examples of Academic Misconduct

- Cheating during quizzes, tests, or exams
- Falsification of evaluations, clinical records, or other official documents
- Plagiarism in assignments or projects
- Misrepresentation of clinical procedures, patient care, or incidents during rotations

Disciplinary Actions

- First Offense: Counseling session and formal warning
- Second Offense: Failure of the involved course and placement on academic probation
- Severe or Repeated Violations: Immediate dismissal from the EMS program for at least one year, with eligibility for reapplication subject to the discretion of program leadership

Progression and Retention Criteria

To remain in the program, students must:

- Academic Performance: Maintain a minimum cumulative grade of 75% across all EMS courses
- Clinical Competencies: Complete 100% of the clinical and field competencies outlined in the program guidelines
- Adherence to Policies: Comply with all academic, clinical, and professional conduct standards

Remediation and Dismissal Policies

Remediation: Students placed on academic or clinical probation must participate in remediation activities, such as additional skills labs, tutoring sessions, or professional behavior workshops, as outlined by the program director or Clinical Coordinator.

Immediate Dismissal: Severe violations of academic integrity, clinical performance, or professional conduct may result in immediate dismissal from the program.

Appeal Process: Students may appeal disciplinary actions through a formal process outlined in the colleges student handbook. Appeals must be submitted in writing within seven days of the notification of disciplinary action.

6. Clinical and Field Experience Guidelines

Clinical Placement Process

Scheduling: Clinical rotations and field internships are scheduled through Sterling Credentials.

- Students must finalize their schedules no less than 14 days in advance
- Schedule requests for clinical and field shifts are due by the 1st and 15th of each month

Shift Cancellations:

- Requests to cancel a scheduled shift must be submitted at least 24 hours before the start time unless the reason is an emergency
- Excessive cancellations or failure to notify the Clinical Coordinator may result in disciplinary action or grade deductions

Internship Site Requirements

To participate in clinical and field rotations, students must meet all site-specific requirements, including:

Criminal Background Check and Drug Screening:

- Conducted through Viewpoint
- Any positive findings may affect eligibility to participate in clinical rotations

Technical Standards:

- Students must meet the technical standards set by clinical and field partners, including physical, cognitive, and emotional requirements

Additional Documentation:

- American Heart Association CPR certification
- Virginia State EMT certification

Students Who Work or Volunteer for EMS Agencies

Students employed by or volunteering with an EMS agency must follow Virginia Office of EMS regulations during clinical rotations.

Third-Rider Status: Students must act solely as third-riders when performing clinical shifts with their agency.

Prohibited Roles: Students may not count clinical time if they are simultaneously working or considered essential personnel for the agency.

First Responder Assignments: Students assigned to an engine company or functioning as a first responder during their scheduled shift may not count that time as clinical experience.

Violations of these regulations will result in the voiding of the clinical shift and all associated patient contacts.

Student Responsibilities and Expectations

Professional Behavior:

- Adhere to all program policies and procedures, including punctuality, confidentiality, and ethical conduct
- Demonstrate respect for patients, peers, instructors, and clinical site staff

Dress Code: Wear the approved program uniform, including:

- Approved program polo, navy or black slacks, and sturdy closed-toe shoes
- Maintain a clean, well-groomed appearance

Conflict of Interest:

- Students may not participate in rotations where preceptors or staff are family members or in any personal relationship that could compromise objectivity

Evaluation and Feedback Procedures

Assessment Criteria: Students are evaluated on clinical skills proficiency, professional behavior, and adherence to program standards.

Documentation: All patient contacts and clinical activities must be documented in the approved format (DCHART, SOAP, or equivalent) via Sterling Credentials. Documentation must be submitted within 72 hours of completing a shift.

Team Leadership Definition

For Paramedic Capstone Field Internship, students must successfully demonstrate team leadership as defined by CoAEMSP standards:

The student has successfully led the team if they have conducted a comprehensive assessment (not necessarily performed the entire interview or physical exam, but rather were in charge of the assessment), and formulated and implemented a treatment plan for the patient. This means that most (if not all) of the decisions were made by the student, especially formulating a field impression, directing the treatment, determining patient acuity, and disposition and packaging/moving the patient. Minimal to no prompting was needed by the preceptor. No action was initiated/performed that endangered the physical or psychological safety of the patient, bystanders, other responders, or crew.

Required Minimum Team Leads:

- Field Experience: EMT - 10 Contacts, AEMT - 10, Paramedic - 30
- Capstone Field Internship: AEMT - 5 Lead, Paramedic - 20 Lead

7. Student Resources and Support Services

Academic Advising

Academic advisors are available to support students in course selection, scheduling, and planning for academic progression. Students are encouraged to meet with their advisor regularly.

Tutoring and Learning Support

The college offers tutoring services for core subjects, including EMS course content and general education courses. Tutoring is available in person and online.

Counseling and Mental Health Services

Critical Incidents: Students involved in critical or high-stress incidents during clinical or field shifts should notify the Clinical Coordinator immediately.

Mental Health Support: Access to Timely Care counselors is available for students who need additional support.

Financial Aid and Scholarships

The college financial aid office provides assistance with tuition, books, and program-related expenses. G3 Tuition Assistance is available for eligible students in high-demand fields including EMS.

Career Services and Job Placement

Graduating students can access resources for resume building, interview preparation, and job placement assistance. The program has strong partnerships with Norfolk Fire-Rescue, Hampton Fire and Rescue, and area EMS agencies.

8. Health, Safety, and Technical Standards

Occupational Risk Policy

This policy ensures the safety and well-being of students, faculty, and staff involved in the Camp Community College EMS Program.

Occupational Risks

Participants in the EMS Program may be exposed to various occupational risks, including:

- Infectious Diseases: Exposure to bloodborne pathogens (HIV, Hepatitis B and C), airborne pathogens (tuberculosis, COVID-19, influenza)
- Physical Injuries: Lifting and moving patients, working in confined spaces
- Chemical and Environmental Hazards: Exposure to hazardous materials, bodily fluids, extreme weather conditions
- Psychological Stress: High-pressure situations, traumatic incidents, and emotional distress associated with patient care

Technical Standards

Students must meet established technical standards required for EMS education and fieldwork:

Physical Demands:

- Strength Requirements: Ability to lift and carry up to 125 pounds independently, 250 pounds with assistance
- Motor Function: Perform tasks involving kneeling, lifting, bending, and standing for extended periods
- Coordination: Maintain motor coordination over uneven terrain while ensuring patient and crew safety

Sensory and Communication Requirements:

- Visual Acuity: Sufficient vision to assess patients and environments accurately
- Auditory Ability: Capability to hear breath sounds, heart tones, and communicate effectively
- Communication Skills: Read, write, and comprehend in English; communicate clearly under pressure

Cognitive and Intellectual Requirements:

- Critical Thinking: Apply reasoning and problem-solving in emergency situations
- Decision Making: Make rapid, accurate decisions in high-stress environments
- Mathematical Skills: Perform medication calculations and unit conversions accurately

Behavioral and Emotional Requirements:

- Professional Demeanor: Maintain composure and professionalism in stressful situations
- Emotional Stability: Handle traumatic situations and patient interactions appropriately
- Teamwork: Function effectively as part of emergency response teams

Safety Protocols and Procedures

Personal Protective Equipment (PPE): Adherence to PPE protocols is mandatory for all clinical and field experiences.

OSHA Training: Before the first clinical rotation, students must complete bloodborne pathogen training through the EMS 120 Canvas Shell.

Hand Hygiene: Emphasis on hand hygiene as the cornerstone of infection prevention.

Emergency Procedures

Illness or Injury: Students experiencing illness or injury during a clinical or field shift must report it immediately to their preceptor and the Clinical Coordinator.

Exposure Incidents: Exposure to bloodborne pathogens, infectious diseases, or hazardous materials must be documented and reported to the Clinical Coordinator immediately.

9. Professional Conduct and Uniform Requirements

Dress Code and Uniform Requirements

Uniform Components

- Shirt: Students must purchase the required Camp Community College EMS Polo Shirt
- Pants: Navy blue or black pants (EMS cargo pants are acceptable)
- Belt: Black belt
- Footwear: Black boots or sturdy black shoes

Uniform Vendor:

Scrubs Plus

1001 Centerbrooke Ln

Suffolk, VA 23434

(757) 922-7010

Cost: \$41.00-\$51.00 plus tax

Cohort-Specific Uniform Colors:

- High School Students: Hunter Green Polo Shirt
- Camp College EMT, AEMT and Paramedic: Navy Blue Polo Shirt
- Paramedic Students: To Be Determined (TBD)

Additional Requirements

- Maintain good hygiene and a clean, pressed uniform
- Cover visible tattoos
- ID Badge: Camp picture ID clipped to the shirt collar
- Fingernails: Clean, well-manicured, sheer colors only. No false fingernails.
- Jewelry: Minimal jewelry. Simple post-type earrings only. Remove facial piercings.
- Hair: Clean, worn off the collar. Beards and mustaches short and neatly trimmed.
- Fragrances: Avoid colognes, after-shave lotions, perfumes, and body sprays
- Make-up: Keep to a minimum

Professional Behavior and Ethics

Adherence to Clinical Site Policies: Students must comply with all rules and expectations set forth by clinical and field internship sites.

Respect for Confidentiality: Students must safeguard patient privacy and adhere to HIPAA regulations.

Social Media Conduct: Refrain from posting about clinical experiences or identifiable patient information on social media.

10. Student Organizations and Community Service

Importance of Community Service in EMS

Community service is an integral part of the EMS profession. It fosters a sense of civic responsibility and promotes public health and safety.

Types of Community Service Activities

- Public Health Campaigns: Attending health fairs, flu vaccination clinics, or blood drives
- CPR and First Aid Training: Teaching basic lifesaving skills to community members
- Emergency Preparedness Education: Promoting readiness through disaster preparedness workshops
- Community Event Support: Standby medical services at marathons, parades, or school sporting events
- Youth Engagement: Volunteering with local schools to inspire interest in EMS careers

11. Graduation and Certification

Graduation Requirements

To graduate from the Camp Community College EMS program, students must:

- Complete all required coursework as outlined in the program curriculum
- Fulfill all clinical rotation and field internship hour requirements
- Achieve satisfactory grades (minimum of 75%) in all program courses
- Pass all final readiness and capstone assessments
- Resolve any outstanding academic, financial, or administrative obligations

Certification Exam Preparation

The program provides comprehensive support to help students prepare for certification exams, including:

- Access to resources for the National Registry of Emergency Medical Technicians (NREMT) and Virginia state certification exams
- Study guides, practice tests, and online resources
- Dedicated review sessions led by program instructors
- Opportunities for additional practice in simulation labs

Licensing and Continuing Education

Graduates are strongly encouraged to maintain their certifications through regular recertification processes. Continuing education opportunities include advanced certifications and specialized training.

12. Program Policies and Compliance

Student Admissions and Academic Progress Policies

Admission Requirements Policy: Admission to the Camp Community College EMS Program requires a current Virginia EMT certification (for AEMT and Paramedic programs), a valid AHA BLS Provider (CPR) certification, and meeting all general college admission requirements.

Advanced Placement / Transfer Credit Policy: Advanced placement or transfer credit may be granted if coursework was completed at a CAAHEP-accredited EMS program, official transcripts and course syllabi are provided, and a competency exam is passed if required.

Readmission Policy: Students seeking readmission must reapply to the program, demonstrate competency in previously covered material, and meet any additional requirements set by the EMS Program Director.

Student Progression and Retention Policy: Students must maintain a grade of C or higher in all EMS courses, attend all scheduled classes, labs, clinicals, and field rotations, and comply with technical standards and code of conduct.

Remediation Policy: Students who fail an exam or skill may be eligible for one remediation opportunity with a remediation plan developed by EMS faculty.

Grading and Evaluation Policy: Student evaluation includes written exams, practical skills assessments, simulation performance, and clinical/field evaluations. A minimum of 75% is required in both didactic and practical components.

Student Records and FERPA Policy: Student records are maintained in compliance with the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA).

Withdrawal and Dismissal Policy: Students may withdraw by notifying the EMS Program Director. Dismissal may occur due to academic failure, clinical misconduct, or attendance violations.

Complaint Handling Policy: All complaints must be submitted in writing to the EMS Program Director. Complaints are logged, acknowledged within 3 business days, and resolved through formal or informal procedures.

13. Appendices

Contact Information for Faculty and Staff

EMS Program Director: Dr. Carlos Cajares, DHSc, MPA, NRP

Email: CCajares@pdc.edu

Phone: 757-582-1899

Medical Director for EMS Education: Dr. Joel Michael, M.D.

Email: JMichael@pdc.edu

Dean of Nursing and Allied Health: Dr. Angela Sheaffer, DNP, RN, CCRN-K

Email: asheaffer@pdc.edu

Adjunct Faculty:

Timothy Doughty - tdoughty@pdc.edu

Scott Maynard - smaynard@pdc.edu

Campus Locations

Franklin Campus / Workforce Development Center

100 North College Drive

Franklin, VA 23851

757.569.6700

Hobbs Suffolk Campus

271 Kenyon Road

Suffolk, VA 23434

757.925.6300

CAMP in Smithfield

253 James Street

Smithfield, VA 23430

757.925.6340

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

How do I access clinical scheduling platforms? Access Sterling Credentials through your Canvas course shell under the resources tab.

What is the policy for missing a shift? Notify the Clinical Coordinator immediately and provide valid reasons for cancellations.

Where can I get my uniform? Scrubs Plus, 1001 Centerbrooke Ln, Suffolk, VA.

What happens if I fail a course? You may be eligible for remediation based on program policies. Consult the Program Director.

How do I submit incident reports? Incident report forms are available in Canvas. Submit completed forms to the Clinical Coordinator.

Glossary of Terms

AEMT: Advanced Emergency Medical Technician - An EMS provider trained in advanced-level pre-hospital care.

ALS: Advanced Life Support - A higher level of emergency medical care including medication administration and cardiac monitoring.

BLS: Basic Life Support - Fundamental pre-hospital care including CPR and AED usage.

CAAHEP: Commission on Accreditation of Allied Health Education Programs.

CoAEMSP: Committee on Accreditation of Educational Programs for the Emergency Medical Services Professions.

DCHART: A standardized documentation method (Dispatch, Chief Complaint, History, Assessment, Rx, Transport).

EMT: Emergency Medical Technician - An entry-level EMS provider.

Sterling Credentials: An online platform for managing clinical scheduling, documenting patient contacts, and tracking skills competencies.

HIPAA: Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act - A federal law protecting patient privacy.

LOR: Letter of Review - Recognition from CoAEMSP for EMS education programs.

NREMT: National Registry of Emergency Medical Technicians - The certifying organization for EMS providers.

VA OEMS: Virginia Office of Emergency Medical Services - The state agency that regulates EMS programs.

Camp Community College EMS Program Student Handbook Acknowledgment and Attestation Form

I, the undersigned, acknowledge that I have received, read, and fully understand the Camp Community College EMS Program Student Handbook. I agree to abide by all policies, procedures, expectations, and standards as outlined in the handbook, including those related to:

- Academic and clinical performance
- Professional conduct and ethics
- Health and safety requirements
- Attendance and participation
- Program progression and dismissal policies

I understand that it is my responsibility to ask questions if any part of the handbook is unclear and to stay informed of updates communicated by the EMS Program.

I further acknowledge that failure to comply with these policies may result in academic or disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal from the program.

By signing below, I affirm that I have reviewed the contents of the EMS Student Handbook and agree to comply with all program requirements.

Student Signature: _____

Printed Name: _____

Date: _____